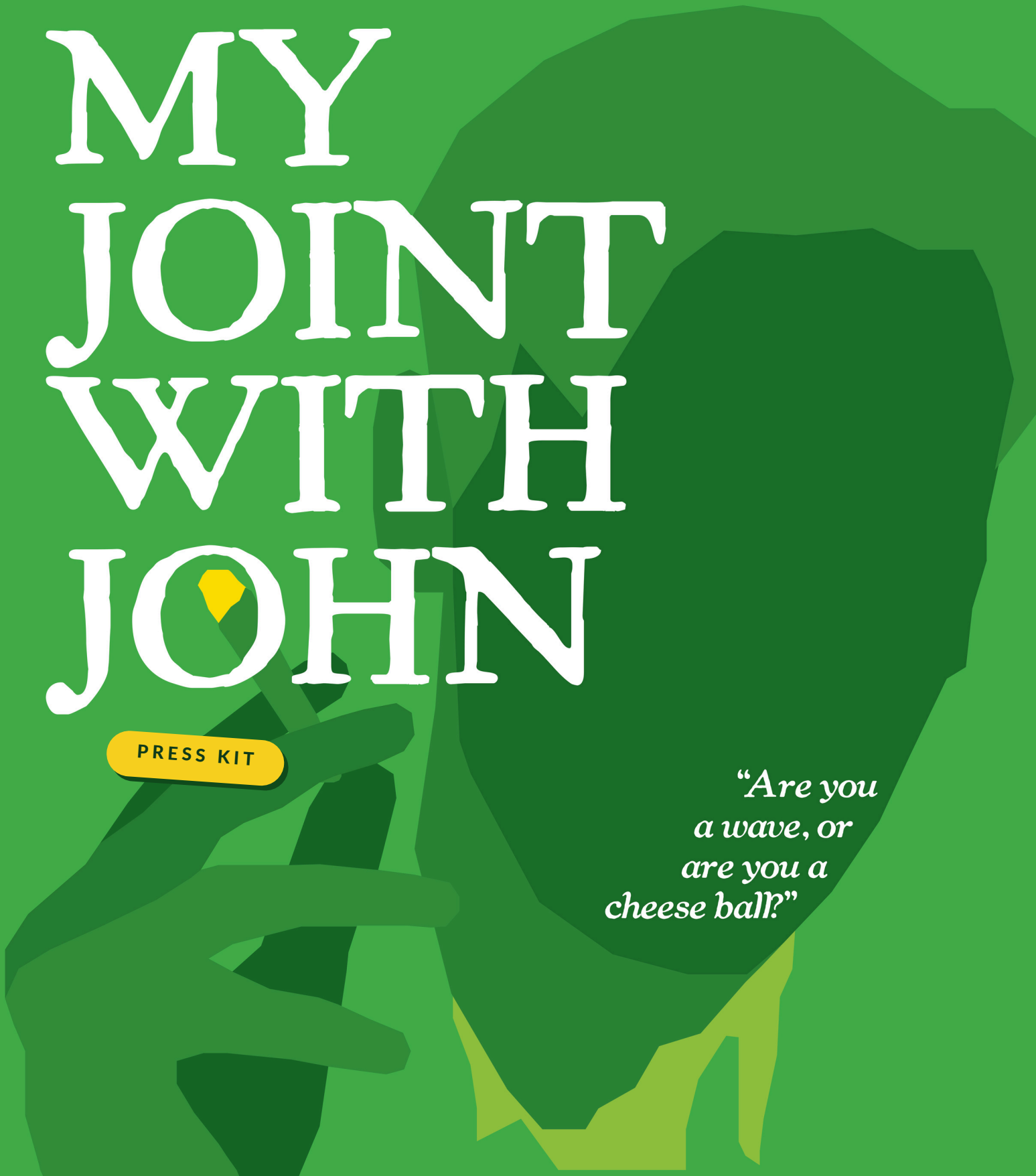
2027

MY JOINT WITH JOHN

PRESS KIT



"Are you a wave, or are you a cheese ball?"

A BAD WRITERS PRODUCTION

STARRING DANIEL PAUL FINBAR CAREY AND NOA MOURITZEN-WARD

CINEMATOGRAPHY BY NICO URIS PRODUCTION DESIGN BY KRISTINA PETROVA

WRITTEN BY NOA MOURITZEN-WARD & BART VAN DE STEEG

DIRECTED BY BART VAN DE STEEG

BAD WRITERS

LOGLINE

A once-hopeful screenwriter on the brink of burnout shares one last joint with his stoner best friend.

SYNOPSIS

Following a devastating pitch, William, a once-hopeful screenwriter on the brink of burnout, returns home questioning whether his dreams were ever worth chasing. Seeking comfort in familiar company, he shares a joint with his stoner best friend, John, hoping to escape the crushing realities of an industry that seems to have no place for them. What begins as another laid-back smoke session soon turns into a bitter reflection on their fading ambitions, creative frustrations, and the uncertain futures that await them.

As the conversation grows increasingly personal, buried resentments and uncomfortable truths begin to surface, forcing the two friends to confront the cracks in their relationship that years of avoidance have only deepened. By the end of the night, their usual ritual has spiralled into something neither could have anticipated, leaving their lifelong friendship hanging by a thread.

COMEDY · DRAMA DIALOGUE-DRIVEN ENGLISH



The Film

RUNNING TIME 18:46 min	COUNTRY OF ORIGIN Germany
GENRE Comedy, Drama	LANGUAGE English
YEAR OF PRODUCTION 2026	SCREENING FORMAT DCP 4K
SOUND 5.1 Surround	ASPECT RATIO 16:9

DIRECTED BY	Bart van de Steeg
WRITTEN BY	Noa Mouritzen-Ward, Bart van de Steeg
PRODUCED BY	Noa Mouritzen-Ward, Bart van de Steeg, Daria Kostina
PRODUCTION COMPANY	Bad Writers
EDITED BY	Bart van de Steeg, Noa Mouritzen-Ward, Fabian Schneider
CINEMATOGRAPHY BY	Nico Uris
SOUND DESIGN	Scott Ramsell

Watch the trailer

Scan the code or follow the link:

youtu.be/9jcXx6_ajdI

COMEDY · DRAMA · 18:46

Director's Statement



BART VAN DE STEEG
DIRECTOR

Bart van de Steeg

My Joint with John is about trying your best and still getting nowhere. About wanting to move forward while somehow pushing away the people you love. It is a coming-of-age story for those too old to have one, yet dread the person they might become. I see myself in both protagonists.

I am William: passionate and hardworking, driven by the desire to make something of myself, yet confused, overwhelmed, and often hopeless.

And I am John: creative, devoted to art above all else, yet paralysed by the fear of doing, retreating into the comfort of easy pleasures instead.

William wants to move forward. John struggles to begin. One is consumed by the need to do something with his life; the other by the fear of actually doing it.

Somewhere between the two lies the contradiction I recognise in myself. Perhaps we all exist somewhere on this William–John spectrum, caught between who we want to be and who we are afraid we might become. We struggle to find a place in the world, and with it, a sense of belonging within ourselves.

With *My Joint with John*, I want to embrace that confusion rather than resolve it.



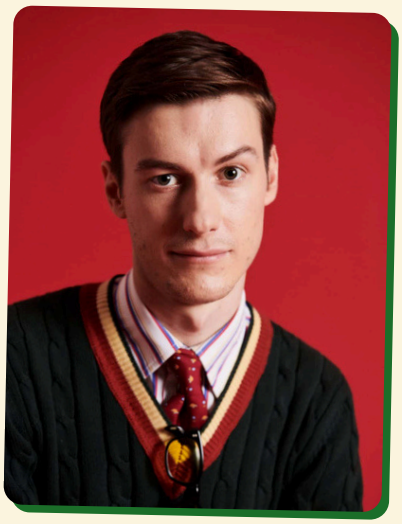
STILLS







The Cast



AS WILLIAM

Daniel Paul Finbar Carey

Born and raised in Luxembourg to Canadian parents. After graduating high school, he attended the Conservatoire de la Ville de Luxembourg – an acting school where lessons are taught in German and French. During his training he played Hamlet in a trilingual production (German, French, English), and after this initial success prepared himself for smaller roles once more.

He played the leading role in *Gruesome Playground Injuries* in Leipzig (English-language production). Currently he is the founding member of the *Tragic Mirth* association. He is known for his Shakespearean productions at the Monbijou Theatre in Berlin.

Daniel is also a playwright, with plays having been shown at various Berlin festivals.



AS JOHN

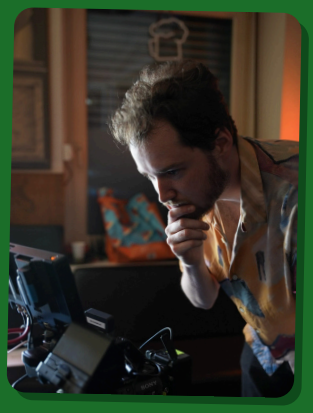
Noa Mouritzen-Ward

Born in Dubai and raised in Spain, Noa spent much of his childhood playing football and writing short stories. His passion for storytelling soon led him into animation, where he voiced multiple characters in the pilot episode of his own animated comedy series. From there, he went on to write short films and sketch comedy, often starring in his own low-budget productions.

His biggest role to date came when he played John in *My Joint with John*.

Noa is currently developing his first feature film, set in Denmark. And, naturally, inspired by how much he enjoyed playing John, he's already writing a role for himself.

The Filmmakers



DIRECTOR / WRITER / PRODUCER / EDITOR

Bart van de Steeg

A Dutch screenwriter, filmmaker, and stand-up comedian. Bart has studied creative writing, filmmaking, and psychology. As an autistic individual, Bart has come to understand that what others call “normal” is often a matter of perspective. What seems obvious to many can strike Bart as strange, absurd, misguided, or unexpectedly funny. He draws on this perspective to explore the world around him, examining everyday events, human behaviour, and the contradictions of life. It finds its way into his short stories, screenplays, stand-up comedy acts, and films. Through his work, he aims to cut through the banality of everyday life and shine a light on both its humour and its sadness. Because life is rarely one or the other. It is the interplay between its highs and lows, its absurdities and its hardships, that makes it worth living.

Bart has written several short stories and short screenplays, as well as two feature films. Whether intentional or not, they naturally develop a humoristic tone and perspective.

My Joint with John is Bart’s directorial debut.



ACTOR / WRITER / PRODUCER / EDITOR

Noa Mouritzen-Ward

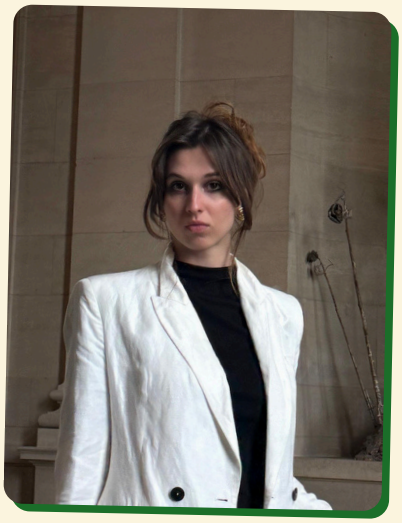
Noa is a Danish-English screenwriter and actor whose passion for writing began at an early age. His first short story won a school-wide writing competition, setting him on a creative path he has pursued ever since. At sixteen, watching *Clerks* by Kevin Smith marked a turning point, cementing his desire to write for the screen.

Drawn to dialogue-driven stories with a comedic edge, Noa is fascinated by the power of conversation: the words people choose, the things they leave unsaid, and the connections that form or unravel between them. For him, relationships are at the heart of storytelling, whether exploring friendship, love, or the complexities of everyday life. His love of dialogue naturally led him to acting, offering him the opportunity to bring his writing to the screen and inhabit the characters and conversations he creates.

Noa has written several short screenplays, a feature-length screenplay, and a pilot season for a comedy animated series.

My Joint with John marks his acting debut.

Behind the Camera



PRODUCER

Daria Kostina

Daria Kostina is a Ukrainian producer based in Berlin. A graduate of MetFilm School, she is passionate about bringing original stories to the screen and collaborating with creatives across various genres and formats.

Her work as a producer spans across short films and music videos. Most notable films: *We will meet again* (2026), *JOY* (2026), *This is not a metaphor for Alcoholism* (2022), *Still Life* (2023), *Nero* by Xava Shoya (2024), *End of the World* by Kings&Pills (2024).

She currently works across documentary and commercial mediums as part of Signature Studios in Berlin.



CINEMATOGRAPHER

Nico Uris

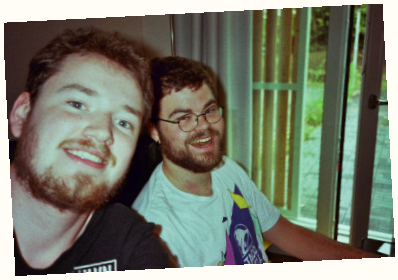
Nico is a Spanish cinematographer based in Berlin, working primarily as a Director of Photography on music videos and short films. While his work has largely focused on music videos, he has increasingly expanded into fiction filmmaking. His multidisciplinary practice extends to producing, writing, shooting, and editing his own short film, *Nothing to Hold On To* (2027).

His DoP credits include *Entre Ser y Estar* (2027), *Despondent Martini* (2027), *All the Colours We Leave Behind* (2027), *By the Fire* (2026), and *My Joint with John* (2026), among others. Nico also worked as co-cinematographer for the California-based feature film, *Devotion* (TBD).

He has also worked as a cinematographer on various documentary projects in Spain and Berlin.

Alongside his filmmaking practice, Nico currently teaches editing and camera at METFilm School Berlin.

Q & A



1 Is the film based on your life?

Yes, somewhat intentional, somewhat unintentional.

We see ourselves much in William, passionate and hardworking, driven by the desire to make something of ourselves. Yet, confused, overwhelmed, and often hopeless.

But we also like how similar we are to John. Creative, devoted to art-above-all, and social. Yet, paralysed by the fear of doing and instead retreating into the comfort of easy pleasures.

2 How did you come up with your idea?

We are in love with what low-budget dialogue-driven films do, like *Clerks* (1994), *Man from Earth* (2007), and – unsurprisingly – *My Dinner with Andre* (1981).

The magic that you feel when people talk in a tiny, confined space, and just see where the conversation goes is what we were looking for.

Such mundane, tight, virtually one-shot locations can surprisingly create memorable experiences that live with audiences for years to come. That is what we aimed to do.

3 What are the lessons you learned?

That filmmaking is difficult, more expensive than we thought, more stressful than we thought and incredibly time-consuming. It's painful. Some things you work on and think about for months or years, just end up on the cutting-room floor.

That said, we would do it all over again.

Q & A

4 Where did you find the crew?

After years spent on other people's sets as best boys, gaffers, first AD's, AC's, actors, and DoP's, we finally cashed in all the favors for our own project. While we worked on so many other projects, creating a network, making friends in the industry, we were writing *My Joint with John*, just waiting for it to be our time to film.

Our crew consisted of people we met in bars, people we met on sets, teachers, friends & partners, virtual strangers, and fellow students.

5 As writers, what was the writing process like?

The most fun you can possibly have; it's our biggest joy in life.

Until after draft ten.

Then it feels like crawling through thick sludgy mud every time you write until you finish the draft. Then you get feedback on the draft, and back to crawling through the mud you go once again, just hoping this time you'll get a few inches closer to something you can finally sign your name off on.

6 For the director, what was it like to direct your friends?

Easy here and there, because we were all on the same page on how we wanted William and John to act.

But it was difficult to trust your own instincts or when to trust your friends and fellow contributors' ideas, as the final decision lies with the director. Having a co-writer who is also the supporting actor is fantastic as we wrote the script together and so we are very in sync, but he also has his exact ideas of how he saw John, while I have mine, and it was about finding compromise on our few differences when on set.

The toughest part is the editing room, having to cut things that worked so well in the script, and then you watch it right in front of you, and it just doesn't quite click. Cutting your darlings is a real thing, and it's painful every time.

Behind the Scenes











Full Credits

STARRING
Daniel Paul Finbar Carey as William
Noa Mouritzen-Ward as John

DIRECTED BY
Bart van de Steeg

WRITTEN BY
Noa Mouritzen-Ward
Bart van de Steeg

PRODUCED BY
Noa Mouritzen-Ward
Bart van de Steeg
Daria Kostina

EXECUTIVE PRODUCER
Christopher Ward

CINEMATOGRAPHY BY
Nico Uris

EDITED BY
Bart van de Steeg
Noa Mouritzen-Ward
Fabian Schneider

SOUND DESIGNER
Scott Ramsell

PRODUCTION DESIGNER
Kristina Petrova

PRODUCTION SOUND RECORDIST
Scott Ramsell
Georgii Malykh

FIRST ASSISTANT DIRECTOR
Bart Christiaanse
Miklós Molnár

FIRST ASSISTANT CAMERA
Teresa Tubert

SECOND ASSISTANT CAMERA
Diego Perret

GAFFER
Nicolas Gombinksy
Rahul Balu Varghese

GRIP
Haakon Keiseraas
Mila Kreft-Sietnicka

SCRIPT SUPERVISOR
Sarah Glittenberg

PRODUCTION DESIGN ASSISTANT
Kata Borbala Kuti
Sarah Glittenberg

RUNNER
Danny Maász
Jesper Madsen

BTS
Ben Rowbury

DRIVER
Laura Krogh

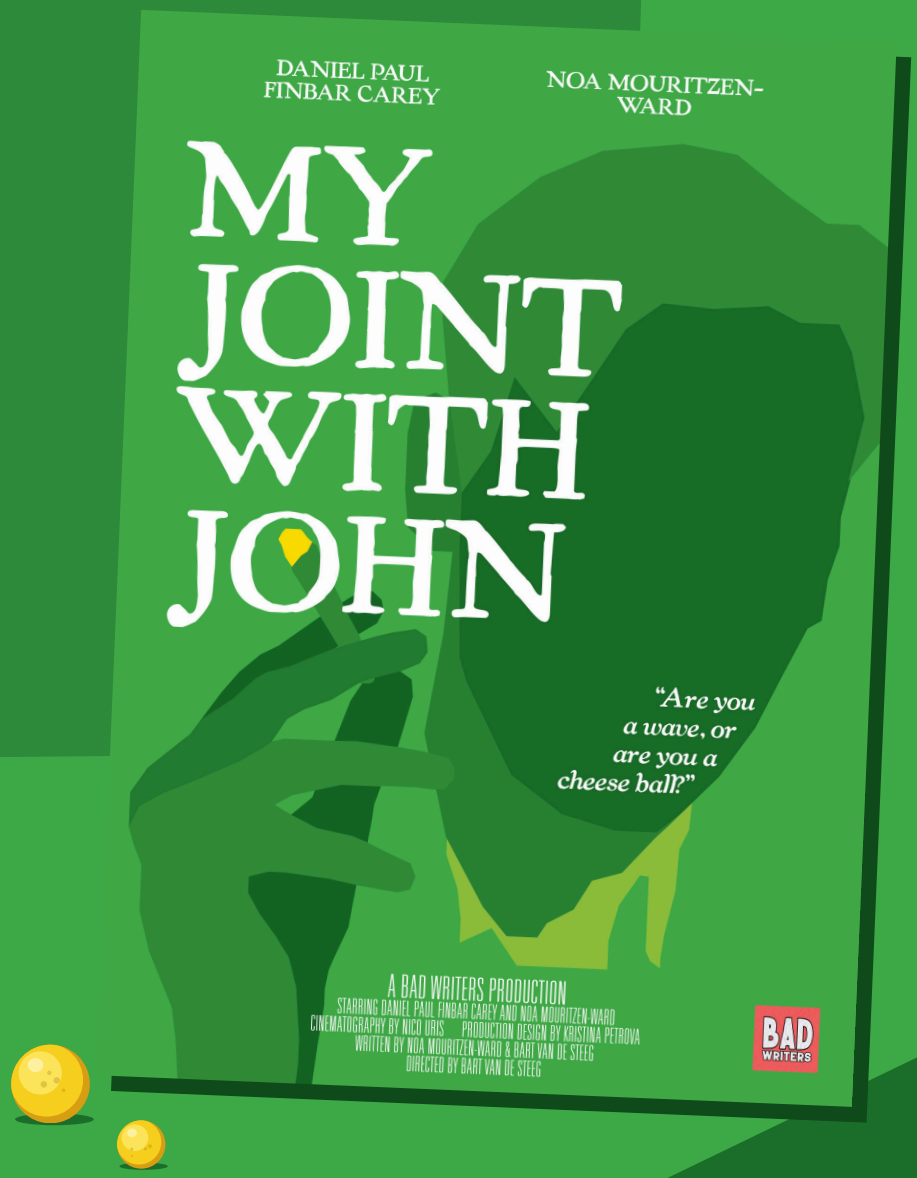
CATERING
Jesper Madsen
Laura Krogh

SCRIPT CONSULTANTS
Leslie Crislip Nielsen
Miles Mantle
Ben Scharf

COLORIST
Nico Uris

ADR RECORDER
Max Bößher

A BAD WRITERS PRODUCTION



Watch the trailer

youtu.be/9jcXx6_ajdI

COMEDY · DRAMA · 18:46 MIN

A BAD WRITERS PRODUCTION

MY JOINT WITH JOHN · 2027